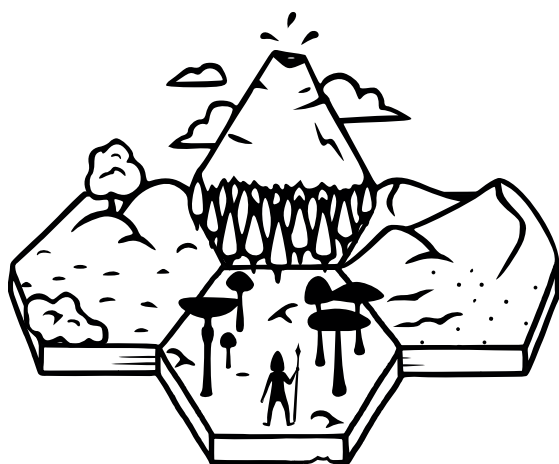


SANDBOX GENERATOR

Biomes Expansion



ATELIER
landestin

SANDBOX GENERATOR

Biomes Expansion

Climates

Climates are the first of two ways described in this supplement to add more biomes, and thus more variation, to a sandbox.

To keep things simple, we define three types of climates (temperate, hot and cold), based only on the mean temperature in the hex (precipitation is not taken into account here).

Use the tables below with the method described on pp. 8-9 of Sandbox Generator to generate hex maps (19 hexes) with climate-related biomes.

Biomes are ordered from the easiest to the hardest to cross.

These tables also show the equivalence between the biomes across the different climates. They can be used to translate them from one climate to another if it were to change (magically or when world building).

To determine the climate of a hex map, use the method that best suits your needs. Three of them are described on the following pages.

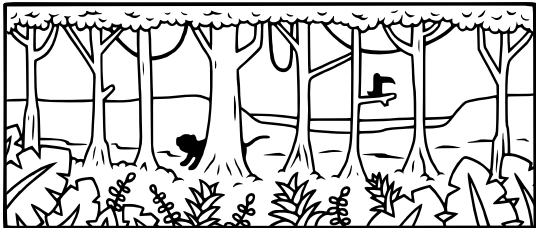
Climate-related biomes

Starting hex

	Temperate	Cold	Hot
1-4	Grassland	Moor	Savanna
5-6	Deciduous forest	Evergreen forest	Tropical forest
7-8	Hills	Tundra	Desert
9	Marsh	Snowfields	Swamp
10	Mountains	Frozen peaks	Plateau

Next hexes

	Temperate	Cold	Hot
1-5	Same as previous hex	Same as previous hex	Same as previous hex
6	Grassland	Moor	Savanna
7	Deciduous forest	Evergreen forest	Tropical forest
8	Hills	Tundra	Desert
9	Marsh	Snowfields	Swamp
10	Mountains	Frozen peaks	Plateau



First method

The first method is to draw two horizontal lines across the world map. The climate between them is temperate. It is cold above and hot below.

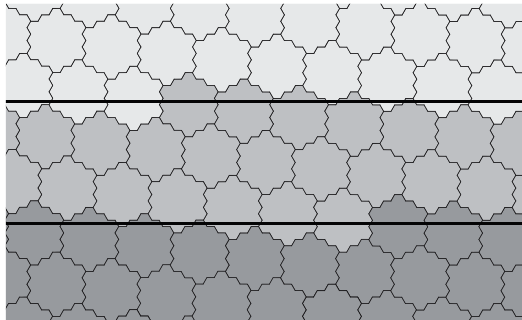
The GM may then choose to assign the same climate to entire hex maps or to individual hexes. In either case, the side with the largest area determines the climate.

It may be easier to generate the biomes of all hexes as if the climate were temperate, and then use the table on the previous page to translate the biomes to the corresponding climate.

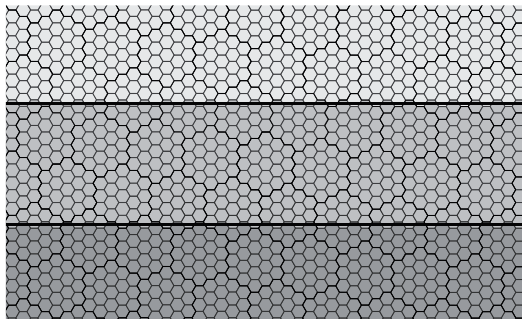
This method can lead to a more believable distribution of climates.

See the examples below (light gray hexes are cold, medium gray are temperate and dark gray are hot):

1. Whole hex maps:



2. Individual hexes:



Second method

The second method is to generate the climate of each new hex map using the “snowflake” method described in Sandbox Generator (see pp. 8-9). Adapt this method by using hex maps instead of hexes and the tables below.

First, either choose the climate of the starting hex map or roll 1d10 on the table below:

1-5	Temperate
6-8	Cold
9-10	Hot

Then, to generate the hexes of the next layers, roll 1d10 on the table corresponding to the climate of the starting hex map:

Temperate

1-6	Same
7-8	Cold
9-10	Hot

Cold

1-6	Same
7-9	Temperate
10	Hot

Hot

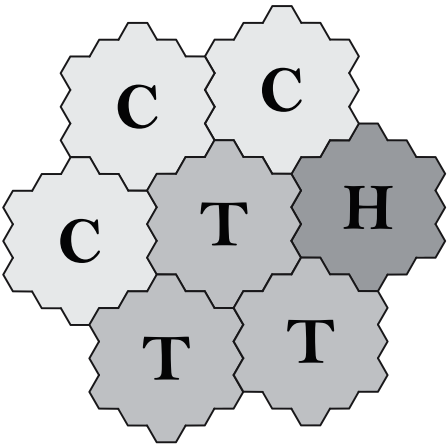
1-6	Same
7-9	Temperate
10	Cold

Example:

We choose that the starting hex map has a temperate climate and roll for the next ones:

Table	Roll	Result
Temperate	7	Cold
Temperate	10	Hot
Temperate	3	Same
Temperate	4	Same
Temperate	7	Cold
Temperate	8	Cold

The result can be seen below:



We finally roll the biome of each hex using the two tables from [p. 4](#).

Third method

The third and final method also uses the tables from the previous page. Instead of rolling for the climate of each hex map, we determine the climate of each individual hex. The “snowflake” method is used here too.

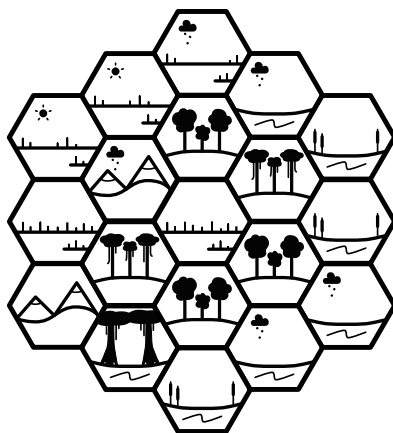
Because this method is more time-consuming, it is recommended to roll the climate for each hex first, then the biome ([using the tables p. 4](#)).

Of course, it will most likely lead to odd situations that may need to be heavily interpreted. This method is mainly described for the sake of completeness.

Example:

We generated the following hex map:

1	Temperate	Grasslands
2	Temperate	Deciduous f.
3	Hot	Tropical f.
4	Temperate	Deciduous f.
5	Temperate	Deciduous f.
6	Hot	Tropical f.
7	Cold	Frozen peaks
8	Cold	Moor
9	Cold	Snowfields
10	Temperate	Marsh
11	Temperate	Marsh
12	Cold	Snowfields
13	Cold	Snowfields
14	Temperate	Marsh
15	Hot	Swamp
16	Temperate	Mountains
17	Temperate	Grasslands
18	Hot	Savanna
19	Hot	Savanna



Hex 3:

This hot climate hex seems out of place next to all these temperate climate hexes. So we can either change it to temperate (making it a deciduous forest instead of a tropical forest, [see table p. 4](#)), or interpret it as a more hot/humid part of the forest. Another interpretation could be it contains exotic plants.

Hexes 18 & 19:

Here we have two savanna hexes sandwiched between grasslands and a moor biome. As in the example above, these could be drier areas. The frozen peaks biome nearby could be the reason the climate changes so abruptly.

Cold biomes encounters

Moor

- 2 Dephasing beasts
- 3 Will o' wisps
- 4 Orcs
- 5 Goblins
- 6 Bandits
- 7 Stags
- 8 Wolves
- 9 Skeletons
- 10 Zombies
- 11 Ghosts
- 12 Werewolves

Snowfields

- 2 Remorhazes
- 3 Frost worms
- 4 Yetis
- 5 Ice trolls
- 6 Polar bears
- 7 Wolves
- 8 Mammoths
- 9 Will o' wisps
- 10 Ice mephits
- 11 Wights
- 12 Frost giants

Evergreen forest

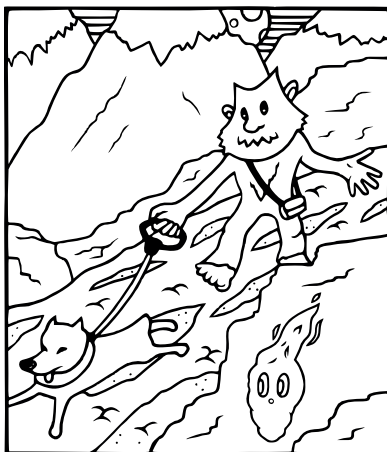
- 2 Beaked bears
- 3 Giant spiders
- 4 Ogres
- 5 Bears
- 6 Gnomes
- 7 Stags
- 8 Wolves
- 9 Bandits
- 10 Orcs
- 11 Giant beavers
- 12 Werewolves

Frozen peaks

- 2 Rocs
- 3 Stone giants
- 4 Yetis
- 5 Ice trolls
- 6 Bears
- 7 Goats
- 8 Smilodons
- 9 Draugar
- 10 Dwarves
- 11 Wights
- 12 Frost giants

Tundra

- 2 Wendigos
- 3 Banshees
- 4 Draugar
- 5 Bisons
- 6 Wolves
- 7 Caribous
- 8 Smilodons
- 9 Berserkers
- 10 Neanderthals
- 11 Mammoths
- 12 Giants



Hot biomes encounters

Savanna

2	Ankhegs
3	Giant beetles
4	Gnolls
5	Hyenas
6	Nomads
7	Antelopes
8	Lions
9	Giant ants
10	Giant bats
11	Rhinoceroses
12	Elephants

Swamp

2	Giant snakes
3	Turtle-men
4	Giant toads
5	Toad-men
6	Stirges
7	Crocodiles
8	Giant snapping turtles
9	Piranhas
10	Shambling mounds
11	Giant leeches
12	Hydras

Tropical forest

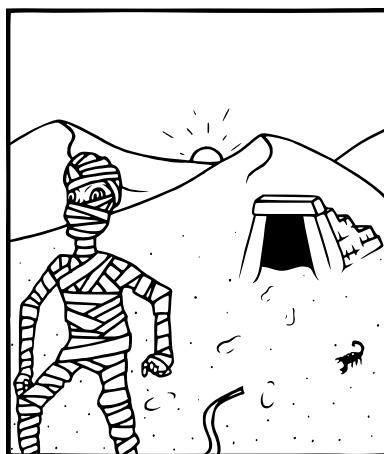
2	Lamias
3	White apes
4	Lizard-men
5	Giant spiders
6	Jaguars
7	Baboons
8	Snakes
9	Snake-men
10	Rakshasas
11	Werejaguars
12	Couatls

Plateau

2	Dracolisks
3	Cyclops
4	Manticores
5	Dwarves
6	Bandits
7	Lamas
8	Cougar
9	Bears
10	Condors
11	Bird-men
12	Rocs

Desert

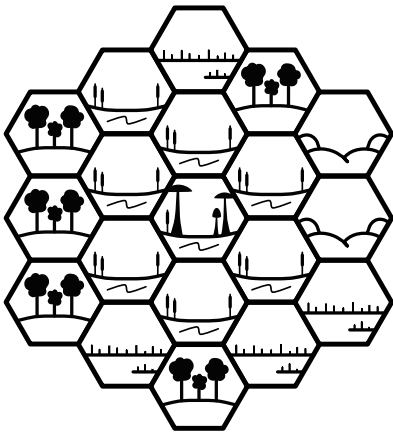
2	Sphinxes
3	Sand-men
4	Giant scorpions
5	Cat-men
6	Mummies
7	Scarab swarms
8	Nomads
9	Giant ant-lions
10	Manscorpions
11	Djinni/Efreet
12	Sandworms



Deep biomes

This second section introduces “deep” biomes, which are rare variations of regular biomes. They appear when a cluster of seven hexes of the same biome is generated. The biome of the central hex is then replaced by a deep biome.

Example (fungal forest):



Deep biomes have less than a 5% chance of appearing (not counting when sticking together multiple hex maps) and should be treated as very special areas. They have their own (small) encounter tables and are more dangerous.

They are meant to represent the more mysterious or eerie parts of the world. But it is also possible to use them instead of the regular biomes.

The three following columns list the biomes of all three climates and their “deep” variations. A small description and an encounter table are also provided for each of them.

Temperate

Regular	Deep
Grassland	Clover field
Deciduous forest	Haunted forest
Hills	Flooded valley
Marsh	Fungal forest
Mountains	Volcano

A **clover field** is an area of grassland where only (or mostly) clovers grow.

- 1-3 Leprechauns
- 4-5 Giant slugs
- 6 Unicorns

A **haunted forest** is the creepy part of the woods, inhabited by spirits.

- 1-3 Werewolves
- 4-5 Ghosts
- 6 Killer trees

A **flooded valley** is the result of torrential flooding or dam failure.

- 1-3 Eels
- 4-5 Fish-men
- 6 Giant beavers

A **fungal forest** is an area where tree-sized mushrooms grow.

- 1-3 Shriekers
- 4-5 Mushroom-men
- 6 Fungoids

A **volcano** is the most dangerous biome, with lava, rocks and ashes.

- 1-3 Fire salamanders
- 4-5 Efreet
- 6 Phoenixes

Cold

Regular	Deep
Moor	Fen
Evergreen forest	Cursed forest
Tundra	Hot springs
Snowfields	Glacier
Frozen peaks	Crystal grounds

A **fen** is a marshy and peaty area where mostly shrubs grow.

1-3 Bog mummies

4-5 Green hags

6 Ghosts

A **cursed forest** is a barren and corrupted area filled with dead trees.

1-3 Skeletons

4-5 Nightmares

6 Wights

A **hot springs** biome is an area with numerous natural warm water pools.

1-3 Bears

4-5 Steam mephits

6 Nereids

A **glacier** is a perennial body of ice and snow that slowly advances.

1-3 Yeti

4-5 Frost giants

6 Remorhazes

A **crystal grounds** biome is a rocky area where crystals of all size grow.

1-3 Frost salamanders

4-5 Stone elementals

6 Crysmals

Hot

Regular	Deep
Savanna	Thorn field
Tropical forest	Primal jungle
Desert	Oasis
Swamp	Toxic swamp
Plateau	Lost valley

A **thorn field** is full of more or less densely packed thorny vegetation.

1-3 Constrictor vines

4-5 Bushtraps

6 Vegepygmies

A **primal jungle** biome is a perilous, unexplored wilderness.

1-3 Carnivorous apes

4-5 Giant snakes

6 Hydras

An **oasis** biome is a body of water where flora and fauna thrive.

1-3 Hippopotamus

4-5 Nomads

6 Manticores

A **toxic swamp** is an inhospitable place where everything is poisonous.

1-3 Spitting cobras

4-5 Giant dragonflies

6 Basilisks

A **lost valley** biome is an area where evolution stopped in prehistory.

1-3 Neanderthals

4-5 Dinosaurs

6 Mastodons

Landmarks

Climate-related biomes

To generate landmarks for climate-related biomes, use the tables provided in Sandbox Generator (see p. 17), but keep in mind that some, if not most, may have to be reskinned to fit the theme.

Examples:

- *Trees or wooden/stone structures can easily be reskinned by stating the type of tree or wood/stone used,*
- *Depending on the climate, water landmarks may be frozen or dry (or in the process of drying up).*

Deep biomes

Some deep biomes have peculiarities:

- Haunted and cursed forests inflict -1 and -2 morale penalties to followers, respectively.
- For each day spent in a fungal forest, save against poison to avoid contracting a disease such as creeping mold (ears/nose/mouth/nails), spore balls (lungs) or redcap eruptions (skin).
- An oasis has a 25% chance of being an illusion.

The tables on this and the following pages provide landmarks for deep biomes. They are intended to be used in place of (or possibly in addition to) those found in Sandbox Generator.

Roll 1d6 on the appropriate table to generate a deep biome landmark:

Temperate

Clover field

- | | |
|---|-------------------|
| 1 | End of a rainbow |
| 2 | Fairy house |
| 3 | Mushroom circle |
| 4 | River |
| 5 | Standing stone(s) |
| 6 | Stone portal |

Haunted forest

- | | |
|---|------------------------------|
| 1 | Blood stained rock |
| 2 | Humanoid-looking tree |
| 3 | Misleading signpost |
| 4 | Scarecrow |
| 5 | Skeleton/Body tied to a tree |
| 6 | Tomb |

Flooded valley

- | | |
|---|---------------------------|
| 1 | Broken bridge |
| 2 | Floating debris |
| 3 | Flooded building |
| 4 | Flooded pit/mine entrance |
| 5 | Mud torrent |
| 6 | Underwater chest/crate |

Fungal forest

- | | |
|---|---------------------------|
| 1 | Hallucinogenic area |
| 2 | Mushroom house |
| 3 | Mushroom-covered building |
| 4 | Phosphorescent mushrooms |
| 5 | Talking mushroom |
| 6 | World mushroom |

Volcano

- | | |
|---|---------------------------|
| 1 | Burnt building/settlement |
| 2 | Burnt trees |
| 3 | Field of charred bodies |
| 4 | Lava flow |
| 5 | Lava pool |
| 6 | Thick ash cloud |

Cold

Fen

- 1 Commemorative cross
- 2 Dead tree
- 3 Mummified body in peat
- 4 Pond
- 5 Ruined cabin
- 6 Small watchtower

Cursed forest

- 1 Desecrated chapel
- 2 Engraved rock
- 3 Gallows
- 4 Mass grave
- 5 Opened tombs
- 6 Path going round in circles

Hot springs

- 1 Cabin
- 2 Geyser
- 3 Pool
- 4 River
- 5 Steam-powered contraption
- 6 Waterfall

Glacier

- 1 Brittle ice
- 2 Cave
- 3 Crevice
- 4 Frozen body
- 5 Frozen prehistoric animal
- 6 Shelter carved in ice

Crystal grounds

- 1 Abandoned mine
- 2 Cave entrance
- 3 Crystallized body
- 4 Floating crystal
- 5 Lake
- 6 Talking crystal

Hot

Thorn field

- 1 Area covered in cobwebs
- 2 Giant cactus
- 3 Insect nest
- 4 Machete-cut path
- 5 Pile of bones
- 6 Sought after flowers/plants

Primal jungle

- 1 Carnivorous plant
- 2 Giant snake skeleton
- 3 Huge eggs
- 4 Liana tangle
- 5 Rafflesia
- 6 River

Oasis

- 1 Ancient god statue
- 2 Caravanserail
- 3 Encampment
- 4 Giant palm tree
- 5 Sandstone ruins
- 6 Waterfall

Toxic swamp

- 1 Decaying stilt cabin
- 2 Giant water lilies
- 3 Metal barrels
- 4 Rope bridge
- 5 Shady boardwalk
- 6 Spiraling root(s)

Lost valley

- 1 Abandoned campsite
- 2 Dinosaur skeleton
- 3 Fallen tree bridge
- 4 Huge footprint(s)
- 5 Mammoth carcass
- 6 Signs of battle

Symbols

Temperate



Grassland



Deciduous forest



Hills



Marsh



Mountains



Clover field



Haunted forest



Flooded valley



Fungal forest



Volcano

Cold



Moor



Evergreen forest



Tundra



Snowfields



Frozen peaks



Fen



Cursed forest



Hot springs



Glacier



Crystal grounds

Hot



Savanna



Tropical forest



Desert



Swamp



Plateau



Thorn field



Primal jungle



Oasis



Toxic swamp



Lost valley

Useful links

AnyDice

anydice.com

Hexographer

hexographer.com

Special thanks

Frédéric Oriol

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